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'Table Contents' settings Reference

Overview



section controls what data is displayed in your table and how it's aggregated.

Table Type

Setting: Table type (Percentage or Mean)

Default: Percentage

Percentage Tables

Used to analyze distributions, proportions, and response rates.

Available Displays:

- **Values:** Raw count or sum
- **Vertical Percentage (%):** Percentage within each column
- **Horizontal Percentage (%):** Percentage within each row
- **Indices:** Index value (typically 100 = average)

Example: In a survey of 100 respondents:



Mean Tables

Used to analyze averages and their statistical properties.

Available Displays:

- **Mean Values:** Average of the metric
- **Count:** Number of observations used in calculation
- **Standard Deviation:** Measure of variability
- **Indices:** Index based on mean values

Example: Average customer satisfaction score:

Display Options

Values

Label: Show values

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

When enabled, displays the raw count or sum in each cell.

Vertical Percentage

Label: Vertical percentage

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Shows each cell's value as a percentage of its column total. Useful for comparing across categories within groups.

Horizontal Percentage

Label: Horizontal percentage

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Shows each cell's value as a percentage of its row total. Useful for comparing category distribution within segments.

Indice

Label: Show indice

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Displays index values (typically with 100 as base). Useful for comparing relative performance against an average.

Calculation: $(\text{Cell Value} / \text{Average}) \times 100$

Masking

❗ WHY USE MASKING WHEN POWER BI CAN FILTER DATA?

When you filter data in Power BI, the underlying data is removed from the visual, which can affect calculations like totals and percentages. Masking allows you to hide specific data points **while still including them in calculations**, ensuring accurate results.

Mask Pattern

Label: Mask Pattern

Type: Text area

Default: Empty

Available in: Pro, Premium editions

Allows you to mask (hide) data from specific rows or columns using regular expressions.

User will input a pattern to match the rows/columns to be hidden. As an example, if you want to show ONLY Brand A and Brand B, you need to hide everything which is NOT Brand A or B.

☐

or better with the IN operator

☐

Therefore, if also you do not want the "No answer" to gender question while still using it in calculations:

☐

etc ...

☐

⚠ Beware of the inverted logic of masking.

The pattern defines what to HIDE, this can be somewhat counter-intuitive at first.

Valid operators are:

- IN - for multiple values

- AND - for logical conjunction
- OR - for logical disjunction
- NOT - for negation
- = - Equals
- != - Not equals
- < - Less than
- > - Greater than
- LIKE - Pattern matching with % wildcard

💡 **<= and >= does not exist**

if you want to filter for years greater than or equal to 2020, you need to use `Year > 2019`

The **LIKE** operator works with the % symbol, for example:



Will hide M'ale' AND Fem'ale', and therefore show only "Not Stated" and "Other"

To show only Male **AND** Female, you need to invert the logic: `NOT Customer_Gender LIKE %ale`

Will show ONLY Male and Female

Use Cases:

- Hide sensitive data in shared reports
- Remove small brands/categories from view
- Focus on top-performing segments
- Filter out "Other" or "Not answered" categories while still taking them into account for calculations

Series Configuration

For detailed series configuration options (Value Series, Base Series, Mean Series, etc.), see:

- [Percentage Series Usage](#) — For percentage tables
- [Mean Series Usage](#) — For mean tables

Best Practices

1. **Choose Table Type First:** Percentage vs Mean fundamentally changes how data is displayed
2. **Limit Display Fields:** Use 2-3 display options maximum for clarity
3. **Use Masking Sparingly:** Masked data is still calculated but hidden
4. **Precision for Business:** Use 0-1 decimal places for most business reporting
5. **Totals Context:** Show totals to help readers understand the base size

Related Settings

- [Totals Settings](#) — Configure total rows and columns
- [Series Configuration](#) — Detailed data mapping
- [Sorting Options](#) — Arrange rows and columns

Troubleshooting

Q: Values appear as "0%" or very small numbers

A: Check that your base series is correctly mapped in percentage series settings.

Q: Indice values don't look right

A: Ensure you've configured both values and base series correctly.

Q: Mask pattern isn't working

A: Check your regular expression syntax. Use simple patterns like `Total` before complex regex.

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#).

Sorting & Ordering Reference

Overview

Customize how rows and columns are arranged in your table with flexible sorting options.

Row Sorting

Sort Method

Setting: Row sorting

Options: None, Row Label (Alphabetical), Column Value

Default: None

When different from 'None', rows are sorted depending on the different settings. Otherwise, rows remain in the order they come from the data source. See [About sorting elements in Power BI](#) section for more details.

None

Rows appear in the order they come from the data source.

Row Label (Alphabetical)

Sorts rows alphabetically by their label.

Example:



⚠ caution

If you use this setting for numeric labels like "1", "2", "3", the **'10'** label will be considered as coming before **"2"** in alphabetical order (1,10,2,3,4...). In such cases, consider using 'Last Row/Column Positioning' to fix specific label ("10") at the end or use the new "find number in row labels" feature.

Column Value

Sorts rows based on values from a specific column you select.

Use Cases:

- Sort products by highest sales
- Rank regions by satisfaction score
- Order responses by frequency

Find number in Row Labels

Setting: Find number in Row Labels

Options: True, False **Default:** False

When enabled, this setting extracts numeric values from row labels for sorting purposes. This is particularly useful when your row labels contain numbers mixed with text.

Example:

Text sorting	Find in number sorting
Brand A (2024)	Brand A (2024)
Brand A (2025)	Brand B (2024)
Brand B (2024)	Brand C (2024)
Brand B (2025)	Brand A (2025)
Brand C (2024)	Brand B (2025)
Brand C (2025)	Brand C (2025)

Example with purely numeric labels:

Text sorting	Find in number sorting
1	1
10	2
2	3
3	4

Text sorting	Find in number sorting
...	...
9	10

Example with ranges in labels:

Text sorting	Find in number sorting
none	from 1 to 50
beyond 100	from 50 to 100
from 1 to 50	beyond 100
from 50 to 100	none

tip

This setting is particularly useful for sorting labels that include years, ages, or other numeric indicators within text. Only the **first number** found in the label is considered for sorting.

If the number is prefixed with a minus sign (e.g., "-5"), it will be treated as a **negative** number.

Sort Direction

Sorting Order

Setting: Row sorting order

Options: Ascending, Descending

Default: Ascending

Controls whether sorted values go low-to-high or high-to-low.

Example (Column Value sorting):

- **Ascending:** Smallest values first (1, 2, 3...)
- **Descending:** Largest values first (...100, 99, 98)

Example (Raw label sorting):

- **Ascending:** Alphabetical order (A, B, C...)
- **Descending:** Reverse alphabetical order (Z, Y, X...)

Sort Properties

Column Property

Setting: Column property

Options: Value, Horizontal Percentage, Indice

Default: Value

When using "Column Value" sort, choose which metric to sort by.

- **Value:** Value of cells (AND Vertical Percentage)
- **Horizontal Percentage:** Percentage within row
- **Indice:** Index value

tip

For percentage tables, sorting by **"Value"** and **"Vertical Percentage"** yield exactly the same order, reason why only 'value', 'horizontal percentage' and 'Indice' options are shown.

Fixed Row/Column Positioning

Force certain rows or columns to stay at the beginning or end, regardless of sort order.

❗ info

In the following settings, multiple labels can be specified separated by commas. The comparison is not case sensitive and enclose labels in double quotes if they contain comma. e.g., `My Brand, My First Competitor` or `"Not Answered", "no, never"`

First Rows

Setting: 'First row(s)' label(s)

Type: Text input

Format: Comma-separated

Example: `My Brand, My First Competitor`

These rows always appear first in your table, even if a sort would normally place them elsewhere.

Last Rows

Setting: 'Last row(s)' label(s)

Type: Text input

Format: Comma-separated

Example: `Not Answered, Other`

These rows always appear last in your table.

Example:



Column sorting

Setting: Column sort on labels

Type: True/False

Example: False

When enabled, columns are sorted depending on their labels alphabetically. Otherwise, columns remain in the order they come from the data source. See [About sorting elements in Power BI](#) section for more details.

Find number in Column Labels

Setting: Find number in Column Labels

Options: True, False **Default:** False

When enabled, this setting extracts numeric values from column labels for sorting purposes. This is particularly useful when your column labels contain numbers mixed with text.

This feature works the same as for row labels. See [Find number in Row Labels](#) section for more details.

First Columns

Setting: 'First column(s)' label(s)

Type: Text input

Format: Comma-separated

Example: `Current Year, Last Year`

These columns always appear first.

Last Columns

Setting: 'Last column(s)' label(s)

Type: Text input

Format: Comma-separated

Example: `Previous Year, Two Years Ago`

These columns always appear last.

About sorting elements in Power BI

Power BI has its own sorting behavior that can interact with SDM Power BI Table's sorting settings. Here are some key points to understand:

- Power BI will use either a logic alphabetical order for rows and columns, either the order it find data in the data source. This depends on the data model and how fields are configured.
- There is a way to create a **custom sort order** in Power BI by creating a separate "sort order" column in your data model and linking it to the field you want to sort. This will naturally send the data in this order to the SDM Power BI Table visual and therefore will not require any sorting setting in the visual itself.
- **Socio Data Management** @ propose **custom** service to help you create automatically such sort columns in your data model if needed from any datasource (SPSS, CSV, Excel, SQL, Triple-S XML etc...). These sort columns are automatically **attached** to the relevant fields in the data model so that **ALL Power BI visuals** (including SDM Power BI Table) will use them for sorting.
- Even if you use the sort settings in the data source, any sorting settings in the SDM Power BI Table visual will override Power BI's sorting.
- **Unless you use either the sort columns trick or the SDM Power BI Table visual sorting settings**, there is **no guarantee** about the order of rows and columns in Power BI, as it can depend on various factors like data refreshes, model changes, etc.

Best Practices

1. **Use Column Sort for Insights:** Sort by the most important metric (sales, satisfaction, etc.)
2. **Use first rows/columns for Key Items:** like your brand or your main topic of research
3. **Use last rows/columns for "Other", "Not answered", undefined or "Missing categories:** Keeps focus on main data
4. **Totals and subTotals columns** are Always fixed before the detailed columns
5. **Alphabetical for Stability:** Use alphabetical sort for consistent report appearance
6. **Limit Fixed Items:** Too many fixed rows makes the table confusing
7. **Consider User Expectations:** Sort in a logical order for your audience

Tips & Tricks

- **Multiple Sort Levels:** Combine with ranking to show top performers visually

- **Dynamic Sorting:** Power BI's interactions allow end-users to click columns to resort (with Power BI native features)
 - **Regional Reports:** Use First/Last columns to keep comparison columns visible while scrolling
-

Troubleshooting

Q: Sort doesn't seem to work

A: Ensure you've selected a sort method other than "None"

Q: My first/last rows aren't appearing

A: Check the exact spelling and case of row labels

Q: Column value sort uses wrong column

A: Verify you selected the correct column in "Row Sort Column" setting

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#).

Ranking Settings Reference

Overview

Automatically rank cells within each column and visualize rankings with numbers, colors, or gradients.

! Edition Availability

Ranking is available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions.

Enable Ranking

Do Ranking

Setting: Do ranking

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Available in: Pro, Premium

Turns ranking on/off for all cells in the table.

Ranking Configuration

Cell Value Property

Setting: Cell value

Type: Dropdown

Options: Value, Horizontal Percentage, Index

Default: Value

Which metric to rank by within each column.

! info

the metric used for ranking **DOES NOT** need to be displayed in the table. You can rank on one metric while displaying another.

 tip

It is an interesting feature to sort on a specific measure but to rank on another measure like 'Sorting my metric vertical percentage but rank on indice'.

 note

Because Vertical Percentage is calculated based on column totals, ranking by **Value** and **Vertical Percentage** yield exactly the same order. Therefore, only 'Value', 'Horizontal Percentage', and 'Indice' options are shown.

Ranking Order

Setting: Ranking order

Options: Greater is first, Lesser is first

Default: Greater is first

Determines what's considered "best" (rank #1).

- **Greater is first:** Highest values get rank 1 (sales, satisfaction, etc.)
- **Lesser is first:** Lowest values get rank 1 (costs, errors, etc.)

Ranking Scope

Setting: Ranking scope

Options: Global, Per Column, Per Row **Default:** Global

Determines how-to rank the cells.

- **Global:** Ranks all cells in the table together
- **Per Column:** Ranks cells within each column separately
- **Per Row:** Ranks cells within each row separately

Examples: **Ranking per column:**

See **level of column** setting below to choose which column level to consider for Global and Per Row ranking.

Level of Column for Global and per-row ranking

Setting: Level of column **Options:** From 0 to N (N = number of column levels - 1)

Default: 1

When using "Global" or "Per Row" ranking scope, choose which column level to consider for ranking.

- **Level 0:** Total of all columns (global or per-row)

- **Level 1:** First level of columns - global

- **Level 1:** First level of columns - per row

- **Level N:** Nth level of columns - global

- **Level N:** Nth level of columns - per row

Ranking Display Options

Display Format

Setting: Ranking display

Options:

- Add a rank # label within cell
- Color from Red to Blue
- Color from Red to Green
- Custom color gradient

Default: Add a rank # label

Rank Label

Shows a numbered badge (1, 2, 3...) in cells. Choose the shape:

Shape Options:

- **Circle:** Round badge
- **Square:** Square badge
- **Rounded Square:** Square with rounded corners

Example:

Color Gradients

Red to Blue:

- Red = lowest rank
- Blue = highest rank
- Good for neutral comparisons

Red to Green:

- Red = low/bad
- Green = high/good
- Commonly understood for positive/negative

Custom Color Gradient:

- Define your own start and end colors
 - Full control over color scheme
-

Color-Based Ranking Settings

When using color display, configure these additional options:

Color Strength

Setting: Color strength

Type: Slider (1-10)

Default: 7

Controls how saturated/intense the ranking colors are.

- **1-3:** Subtle colors, barely noticeable
- **4-7:** Standard intensity
- **8-10:** Bold, highly visible colors

Use Value for Color

Setting: Use value for color

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Normally, colors are based on rank position (rank 1, 2, 3...). Enable this to base colors on actual cell values instead.

Example:



Auto Font Color

Setting: Auto font color

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Automatically adjust text color (black/white) based on background color for better readability.

Useful for: Color-based gradients to ensure text is always readable

Exclude Middle Range (Advanced)

Exclude certain values from being colored/ranked, useful for "neutral" zones.

Prevent Middle Range from Coloring

Setting: Prevent middle range from coloring

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Available in: Premium

When enabled, values between two thresholds are left uncolored.

Exclude Range

When "Prevent middle range" is enabled:

Exclude From (Start value)

Exclude To (End value)

Values in this range remain neutral (no color or styling).

Example:

Custom Color Gradient

Available in **Premium** edition with "Custom color gradient" display option.

Color From

Type: Color picker

Default: White

The color for lowest-ranked values.

Color To

Type: Color picker

Default: Black

The color for highest-ranked values.

Practical Examples

Example 1: Sales Performance (Pro Edition)



Example 2: Cost Analysis

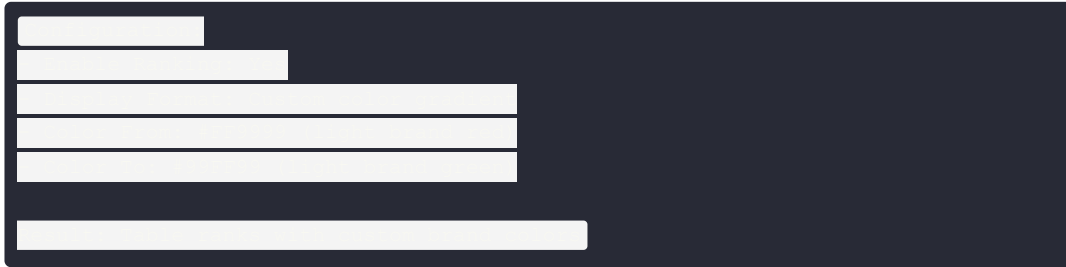


Example 3: Satisfaction with Neutral Zone





Example 4: Custom Brand Colors (Premium)



Best Practices

1. **Choose Appropriate Order:** "Greater is first" for positive metrics, "Lesser is first" for costs/errors
 2. **Keep It Simple:** Use ranks OR colors, not both simultaneously
 3. **Color Strength:** Use 7-8 for reports, 5-6 for dense data tables
 4. **Font Color:** Enable auto font color with strong gradients
 5. **Neutral Zones:** Use exclude range for naturally neutral metrics (satisfaction 40-60% might be "neutral")
 6. **Test Accessibility:** Ensure colors are distinguishable for color-blind readers
-

Troubleshooting

Q: Rankings show but colors aren't appearing

A: Check that you've selected a color display option (not "rank label")

Q: Color gradient goes the wrong direction

A: Verify "Ranking Order" matches your expectations (Greater/Lesser)

Q: Rank numbers are hard to read

A: Enable "Auto Font Color" or adjust colors in formatting

Q: Values seem to rank incorrectly

A: Check that "Cell value" property matches your intention (Value, %, Indice)

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#).

Significance Testing Reference

Overview

The Socio Data Management Power BI cross table tool lets you identify statistically significant differences between groups in your data in several manner, depending on your edition (Pro or Premium) and configuration. All features includes:

- Two independent significance tests per table
- Multiple test types (All columns, Item vs other, Item vs total, Regex)
- Various display options (icon, font color, background color, border color)
- Configurable confidence levels (90%, 95%, 99%)
- Configurable variance methods for percentage tables (pooled, separate)

! Edition Availability

- **Basic significance:** Available in **Pro** edition
- **Advanced significance:** Available in **Premium** edition

Test Configuration

Significance Test 1

Setting: Significance 1

Options: None, All columns, Item vs other question item, Item versus Total (Base), Regular expression

Default: None

Significance Test 2

Setting: Significance 2

Options: Same as above

Default: None

Each test compares different aspects of your data.

Test Types Explained

None

No significance testing is performed.

All Columns

Compares each column against all others in the table.

ⓘ You are limited to 156 unique symbols for marking significance. Here is a list of the 156 symbols:

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZabcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyzαβγδεζηθικλμνξοπρστυφχψωΓΔΘΛΞΠΣΦΨΩΑΒΓΔΕ

Use Case: Determine which regions have significantly different satisfaction scores

Example:

Note that when you have more than one level of column, the significance markers will appear differently per level to avoid confusion.

Available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions.

Item vs Other Question Item

Compares one response option against all others.

ⓘ important

This test is the most used for survey data analysis. You should always prefer this test vs '*Against Total*' when comparing response options.

Use Case: Highlight if one product preference is significantly different

Example:

Available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions.

Item versus Total (Base)

Compares each item to the overall average at the same level.

⚠ warning

This test has been implemented for legacy purpose and is not generally recommended for any analysis. The reason is that observation (population) of the tested values should ***always be independent***. In this test the observations of each cell is included in the total so it does not ensure this independency rule. Unless you have a **good** reason, prefer the *'Item vs Other Question Item'* test instead.

Available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions.

Regular Expression

Uses a regex pattern to identify columns to compare.

This option is extremely useful when you are focusing on a brand, a population or a product and want to know which "*competitors*" are significantly lower or higher.

Example 1: You want to compare the age group "50-70 years" against all other age groups in a satisfaction survey.

In this example, we have two levels of columns but the regex matches only one item on the first level (50-70):

The regex pattern used here is `50-70` which matches partially the column with label "50-70 years".

Example 2: You want to compare respondents who answered "yes, once or twice" against all other response options in a survey question split by age groups.

In this second example, we match on level two, "yes, once" ich matches columns "Yes, once or twice" under each age group: In this case, only every columns compares to this matched column in each subgroup:

Available in **Premium** edition only.

Confidence Level

Significance Level

Setting: Significance level

Options: 90%, 95%, 99%

Default: 95%

The confidence threshold for determining significance.

- **90%:** More lenient (flags more differences)
- **95%:** Standard business level
- **99%:** Strict scientific standard

info

You usually do not change this settings. Choose a higher level (99%) for critical decisions.

Variance Method (Percentage Tables Only)

Setting: Signif. Var. Method

Options: Pooled proportion, Separate proportion

Default: Pooled

Available in: Pro, Premium

How variance is calculated when comparing percentages.

- **Pooled:** Treats all groups as one population (more conservative)
- **Separate:** Treats groups separately (more sensitive to differences)

tip

In usual situation, leave the default to **Pooled proportion**.
Choose **Separate proportion** option when group sizes differ greatly.

Display Options

View Option

Setting: Significance view option

Options: Icon, Font Color, Background Color, Cell border Color

Default: Icon

How significant values are marked:

Icon: Small symbol/marker appears in cell (Red for significantly lower, Green for significantly higher)

--	--

Font Color: Text color changes red or green to highlight significance

--	--

Background Color: Cell background changes red or green to highlight significance

--	--

Border Color: Cell border changes red or green to highlight significance

--	--

Advanced Testing (Premium Only)

Multiple Test Configuration

In Premium edition, you can configure each test independently:

- Different display methods for each test
- Different test types simultaneously
- Regex patterns for flexible comparison

--	--

Hide First Variable

Hides the first variable in comparative displays for cleaner visuals (see masking in [table-content](#)).

Statistical Background (For Reference)

What Tests Are Used?

For percentage tables: **Chi-square test** of independence

For mean tables: **T-tests** or **ANOVA** (depending on number of groups)

Interpretation

A cell marked as significant means:

- The difference between groups is unlikely due to chance
- At the chosen confidence level
- Given the sample sizes

Important Notes

- Significance depends on sample size (large samples show more differences)
 - Practical significance $\neq$ statistical significance (a 1% difference might be statistically significant but not practically important)
 - Always consider context, not just statistics
-

Series Configuration for Testing

Significance tests require special data series:

For Percentage Tables:

- **Significance Series:** The counts/values used for testing
- **Base Series:** The total base for calculating proportions

For Mean Tables:

- **Mean Series:** The mean values to test
- **Standard Deviation Series:** Measure of variability
- **Count Series:** Sample size

Configure these in data settings under:

- "Significance Series" (percentage tables)
 - "Mean Series for Significance" (mean tables)
-

Best Practices

1. **Choose Appropriate Test:** Match test type to your question (all columns vs vs-total)
 2. **Clear Display:** Use one view option per test for clarity
 3. **Document Level:** Note which significance level you're using in reports
 4. **Consider Sample Size:** Small sample sizes can miss real differences
 5. **Practical Significance:** Don't rely solely on statistics; consider business context
-

Troubleshooting

Q: Significance markers don't appear

A: Ensure you've configured significance series in data settings

Q: All cells are marked significant

A: Your significance level might be too lenient (90%); try 99%

Q: No cells marked significant

A: Check sample sizes; very small groups won't show significance

Q: Significance test types are grayed out

A: Significance testing requires Pro or Premium edition

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#) or contact support.

Totals & Subtotals Reference

Overview

Configure total columns, base rows, and subtotals to provide context and summary information in your cross-tabulation tables.

Total Columns

Show Table Total Column

Setting: Show Table Total Column

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Displays a total column that sums all values across the table.

Position: Appears as the first column (leftmost) in the table

Example:

Use Cases:

- Quick reference to overall totals
- Comparing individual segments to total
- Understanding proportional contribution

Show Level 1 Sub-Total

Setting: Show Level 1 Sub-Total

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Displays subtotal columns for the first level of column hierarchy.

When It Appears: Only when you have hierarchical columns (multiple column levels)

Example:

The blue "Total" columns show Level 1 subtotals.

Show Level 2 Sub-Total

Setting: Show Level 2 Sub-Total

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Displays subtotal columns for the second level of column hierarchy.

When It Appears: Only when you have 3+ levels in column hierarchy

Example:

This example shows both Level 1 and Level 2 subtotal columns.

This example shows Level 2 subtotal columns without Level 1.

Base Rows

Base rows display the sample size or denominator used in calculations. Essential for understanding data reliability.

The example shows the three different base rows available.

Show Base Row

Setting: Show Base Row

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Displays a row showing the "Base" series selected in the [Percentage Series setting](#) or [Mean Series setting](#).

What It Shows:

- For percentage tables: The denominator used to calculate percentages
- For mean tables: The count of observations

Example:

Why It Matters:

- Small bases = less reliable percentages
- Helps readers judge statistical significance
- Required for proper interpretation

Show Unweighted Base Row

Setting: Show Unweighted Base Row **Type:** Toggle **Default:** Off

Displays a row showing the unweighted (raw) sample size.

When to Use:

- When your data is weighted in base series
- For transparency in research reporting
- To show actual number of observations/respondents

Example:

Difference from Base:

- **Base:** Reflects weighting adjustments
- **Unweighted:** Raw count of records/respondents

Show Signif Base Row

Setting: Show Signif Base Row

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Available in: Premium

Displays a separate base row used specifically for significance testing calculations.

⚠ warning

This setting cannot be enabled unless you have set one significance method in the [Significance Testing settings](#).

When to Use:

- When significance tests use different data than display values
- Complex weighting scenarios
- Specialized statistical testing

Example:

Row Labels

Customize the text labels for base rows.

Base Row Label

Setting: Base Row Label

Type: Text input

Default: "Base Row"

The label that appears for the weighted base row.

Common Labels:

- "Base"
- "Total N"
- "Sample Size"
- "Weighted Base"
- "n="

Example:

Unweighted Base Row Label

Setting: Unweighted Base Row Label

Type: Text input

Default: "Unweighted Base"

The label for the unweighted base row.

Common Labels:

- "Unweighted n"
- "Raw Base"
- "Actual Count"
- "Sample (unwtd)"

Signif Base Row Label

Setting: Signif Base Row Label

Type: Text input

Default: "Signif Base"

Available in: Premium

The label for the significance testing base row.

Common Labels:

- "Signif n"
- "Test Base"
- "Statistical Base"

Row Positioning

Base Rows on Top of Table

Setting: Base Rows on Top

Type: Toggle

Default: On

Controls whether base rows appear at the top or bottom of the table.

On (Default): Base rows appear immediately below headers

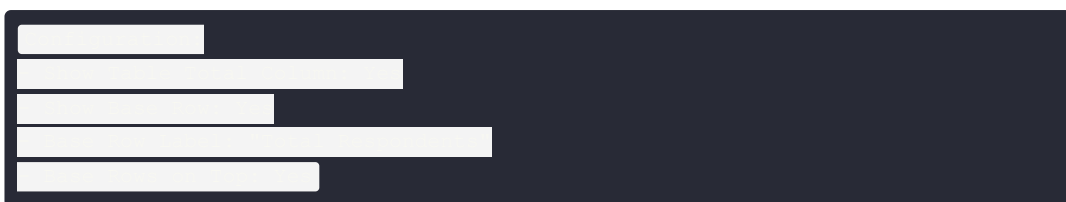
Off: Base rows appear at the bottom

Best Practices:

- **Top:** Better for reports where base size is critical (research, surveys)
- **Bottom:** Cleaner look for executive dashboards
- **Top:** Standard in market research industry

Practical Examples

Example 1: Basic Survey Table





Result:

Example 2: Weighted Research Study



Result:

Example 3: Multiple Row/Columns Analysis



Example 4: Clean Dashboard Style**Best Practices****1. Always Show Base Rows**

Base rows are critical for proper interpretation. Only hide them if:

- Space is extremely limited
- Audience is very familiar with the data
- Bases are identical across all columns

2. Unweighted Bases for Research

When reporting weighted data:

- Always show both weighted and unweighted bases
- Label them clearly to avoid confusion
- Place unweighted base directly below weighted base

3. Label Clarity

Use industry-standard labels:

- **Market Research:** "Base", "Unweighted Base"
- **Academic:** "N", "n (unweighted)"
- **Business:** "Total", "Sample Size"

4. Position Based on Audience

- **Research/Technical:** Bases on top
- **Executive/Business:** Consider bases on bottom
- **Reports with many rows:** Bases on top for reference

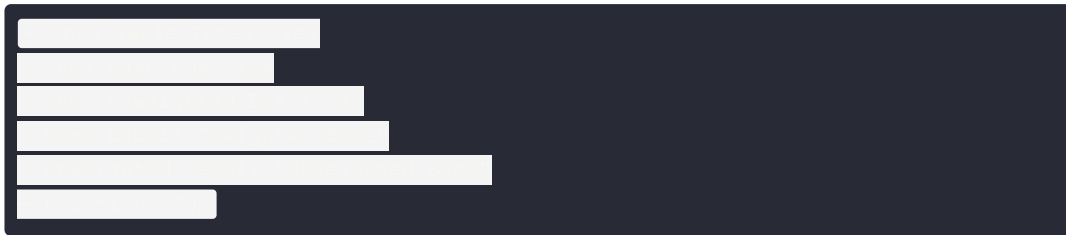
5. Subtotals in Hierarchies

Enable Level 1 and Level 2 subtotals when:

- You have 2+ levels of column grouping
- Subtotals provide meaningful insights
- Table isn't too wide already

Common Configurations

Standard Market Research



Business Dashboard



Academic/Scientific



Executive Summary



Data Series Configuration

For base rows to display correctly, ensure proper series mapping:

For Percentage Tables

- **Base Series:** Set in "% series usage" settings
- **Unweighted Base Series:** Set in "% series usage"
- **Signif Base Series:** Set in "% series usage" (if using significance)

For Mean Tables

- **Count Series:** Set in "Mean series usage" (acts as base)
- **Unweighted Base Series:** Set in "Mean series usage"

See [Percentage Series](#) and [Mean Series](#) for detailed configuration.

Statistical Context

Why Base Sizes Matter

Small Bases (<30):

- Percentages are unreliable
- Use thresholds to mask or warn
- Consider combining categories

Medium Bases (30-100):

- Percentages acceptable but note limitations
- Significance tests may not detect real differences

Large Bases (100+):

- Reliable percentages
- Significance tests have good power

Weighted vs Unweighted

Weighted Base:

- Adjusted to match population proportions
- Use for percentage calculations
- May differ significantly from raw count

Unweighted Base:

- Actual number of records/respondents
- Use to judge reliability
- Important for transparency

Rule of Thumb: Show both when weighting is applied.

Troubleshooting

Q: Base row doesn't appear

A: Ensure you've mapped the Base Series in percentage/mean series settings

Q: Unweighted base is identical to weighted base

A: Your data likely isn't weighted; consider hiding unweighted row

Q: Base values look wrong

A: Check series mapping; ensure you're using the correct measure

Q: Subtotals don't appear

A: Subtotals only show with hierarchical column structures (2+ levels)

Q: Can I show bases in cells instead of rows?

A: No, bases are always shown as separate rows; consider custom formatting

Q: Base rows break my table layout

A: Try positioning them at bottom, or reduce font size in formatting

Related Settings

- [Table Contents](#) — Overall table configuration

- [Percentage Series](#) — Map base data series
- [Mean Series](#) — Configure count series
- [Thresholds](#) — Mask low base values

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#) or contact support.

Percentage Series Configuration

Overview

Configure which data series (measures) are used for different calculations in percentage tables. Proper series mapping is essential for accurate percentages, bases, and significance testing.

ⓘ Edition Availability

All series configuration is available in **Free**, **Pro**, and **Premium** editions.

Understanding Series

In Power BI, a **series** is a measure or calculated field that contains numerical data. For percentage tables, you need to map different series to different purposes:

- **Value Series:** The numerator (what you're counting)
- **Base Series:** The denominator (what you're dividing by)
- **Additional Series:** For significance testing and unweighted bases

Core Series Configuration

Value Series

Setting: Value Series

Required: Yes

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

The primary data series used to populate cell values.

What It Contains:

- For single response: Count of respondents selecting each option
- For multiple response: Count of respondents mentioning each item
- For weighted data: Weighted counts

Example:


**Common Sources:**

- `COUNT(ResponseID)`
- `SUM(Weight)`
- `COUNTROWS(Responses)`
- Pre-calculated measure from your data model

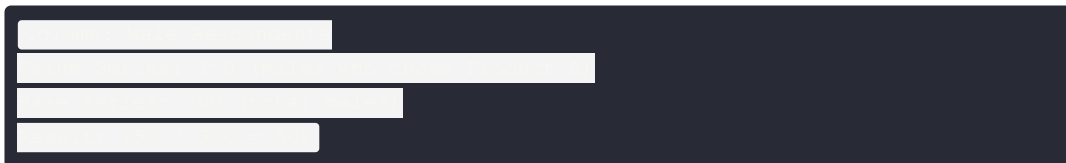
Base Series**Setting:** Base Series**Required:** For accurate percentages**Type:** Dropdown (lists available measures)

The denominator used to calculate percentages.

What It Contains:

- Total count of respondents in each column
- Total population for the segment
- Weighted base (if using weights)

Calculation:

**Example:**

**Common Sources:**

- `COUNT(DISTINCT RespondentID)`
- `SUM(Weight)` (for weighted base)
- Pre-calculated base measure

Important: Base Series should match the scope of your analysis:

- For column percentages: Base = column total
- For row percentages: Base = row total
- For total percentages: Base = grand total

Unweighted Base Series**Setting:** Unweighted Base Series**Required:** Only if using weighted data**Type:** Dropdown (lists available measures)

The raw count of respondents/records before any weighting adjustments.

When to Use:

- Your data is weighted (demographics, quotas, etc.)
- You need to show actual sample sizes
- For research transparency

What It Shows:



Example:



Why It Matters:

- Shows actual sample size (reliability indicator)
- Required for professional research reporting
- Helps readers understand data confidence

Response Mode Configuration

Multiple Answer Mode

Setting: Multiple answer?

Type: Toggle

Default: Off

Controls how percentages are calculated for questions allowing multiple selections.

Single Response Mode (Toggle Off)

Used when respondents select **one option only**.

Characteristics:

- Column percentages sum to 100%
- Each respondent counted once per column
- Standard cross-tabulation

Example:



**Multiple Response Mode (Toggle On)**

Used when respondents can select **multiple options**.

Characteristics:

- Column percentages may exceed 100%
- Each respondent can be counted multiple times
- Base = total respondents (not total mentions)

Example:**Calculation in Multiple Mode:****When to Use:**

- "Select all that apply" questions
- Multiple choice questions
- Attribute tracking (features, behaviors, etc.)

Significance Testing Series

These series are used when performing statistical significance tests.

Significance Series

Setting: Significance Series

Required: Only if using significance tests

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

Available in: Pro, Premium

The data series used for calculating significance tests.

What It Should Contain:

- Same type of data as Value Series
- May be identical to Value Series
- Could be different if testing on different data

Common Scenarios:**Scenario 1: Same as Value Series**




Scenario 2: Different Series




Why Separate?:

- Research methodologies may require testing on unweighted data
- Display and testing may use different rules
- Specialized weighting scenarios

Base Significance Series

Setting: Significance Base Series

Required: Only if using significance tests

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

Available in: Pro, Premium

The base used for calculating proportions in significance tests.

What It Should Contain:

- Denominator for significance calculations
- May match Base Series or be different
- Must align with Significance Series

Example:




Common Configuration:





Series Mapping Strategy

Strategy 1: Simple Unweighted Data

Best for: Internal analysis, no weighting needed



Strategy 2: Weighted Data (Display Only)

Best for: Weighted reporting without statistical tests



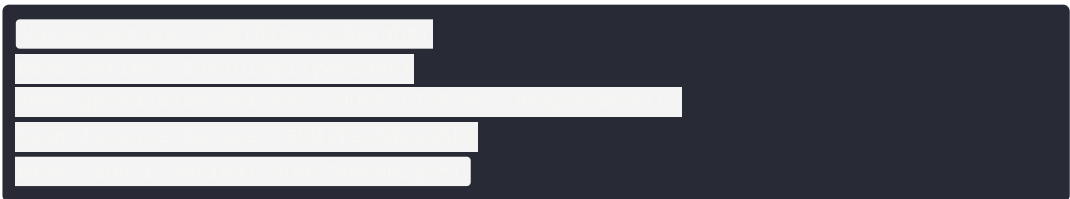
Strategy 3: Weighted Data with Testing

Best for: Professional research with significance tests



Strategy 4: Complex Weighting

Best for: Multiple weighting schemes, advanced research



Practical Examples

Example 1: Basic Survey (Unweighted)



Example 2: Weighted Research Study



Example 3: Product Usage Tracking



☐

Data Model Requirements

Required Measures

For proper percentage tables, ensure your data model includes:

1. Value Measure

☐

2. Base Measure

☐

3. Unweighted Base (if needed)

☐

4. Significance Measures (if testing)

☐

Common Patterns

Pattern 1: Standard Survey Cross-Tab

☐

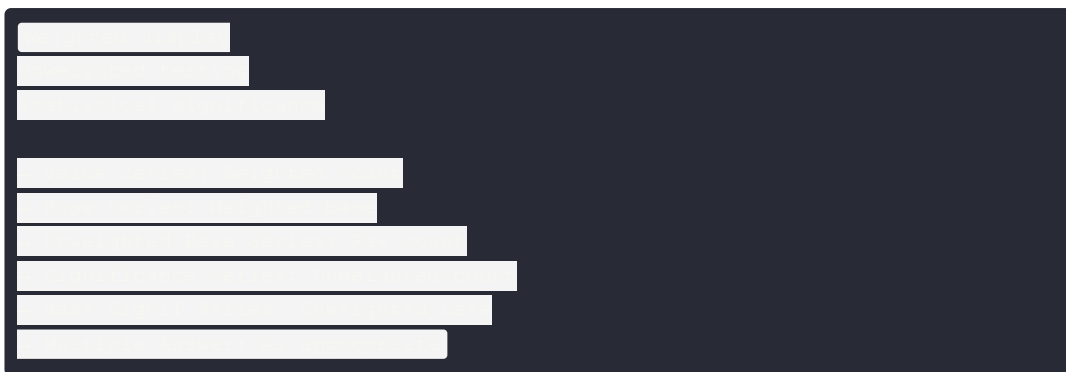
Pattern 2: Multiple Response Analysis



Pattern 3: Weighted Research



Pattern 4: Full Statistical Analysis



Troubleshooting

Q: Percentages don't add to 100%

A: Check your configuration:

- Single response: Verify Base Series matches column scope
- Multiple response: This is normal; ensure "Multiple Answer" is ON

Q: Percentages look wrong (too high/low)

A:

- Verify Value Series and Base Series are properly matched
- Check Base Series is at correct grain (respondent level, not response level)
- For weighted data, ensure both use same weight field

Q: Unweighted base is identical to weighted base

A: Your data likely isn't weighted; you can hide the unweighted row

Q: Base values don't match expectations**A:**

- Check your measure definitions
- Verify filter context in DAX
- Ensure DISTINCTCOUNT on respondent ID, not response count

Q: Significance tests don't work**A:**

- Verify Significance Series and Base Signif Series are mapped
- Check that measures return values
- Ensure series contain appropriate data for testing

Q: Can I use the same series for multiple purposes?

A: Yes, especially for simple unweighted data. Just select the same measure for Value/Base/Significance as appropriate.

Best Practices

1. **Match Series Properly:** Value and Base must use same weighting
 2. **Test Your Measures:** Verify measures in a matrix visual first
 3. **Document Your Setup:** Note which series maps to what in your model
 4. **Consistent Naming:** Use clear measure names (e.g., "Weighted_Value", "Unweighted_Base")
 5. **Validate Results:** Check a few cells manually to ensure correct calculation
 6. **Multiple Response:** Always verify "Multiple Answer" setting matches question type
 7. **Significance Setup:** Test significance configuration on simple data first
-

Related Settings

- [Table Contents](#) — Overall table type and display
 - [Totals & Subtotals](#) — How bases display in table
 - [Significance Testing](#) — Configure statistical tests
 - [Mean Series](#) — For mean table configuration
-

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#) or contact support.

Mean Series Configuration

Overview

Configure which data series (measures) are used for mean (average) calculations, statistical properties, and significance testing in mean tables.

📘 Edition Availability

- Mean tables: Available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions
- All series configuration available in both Pro and Premium

Understanding Mean Tables

Mean tables display **average values** rather than percentages or counts. They're used for:

- Customer satisfaction scores
- Performance metrics (ratings, scores, times)
- Financial averages (revenue per customer, average order value)
- Measurement data (temperature, weight, distance)

💡 tip

Mean tables are ideal for continuous data where averages and variability matter. Continuous (or numeric) data are indicated within Power BI with a sigma (Σ) symbol next to the measure name (here under L2 and L5).

Example Mean Table:

Mean table showing average score of customer recognition by media channel and survey cell

warning

The component itself **DOES NOT** calculate means directly. You must provide appropriate measures from your data model for each series (Average, Count, Std Dev, etc.) or a pre-calculated measure for weighted mean. See the **Data Model Requirements** section for details on creating these measures.

Core Series Configuration

Mean Series

Setting: Mean Series

Required: Yes

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

The primary data series containing the values to be averaged.

What It Contains:

- Individual measurements or scores
- Pre-calculated means (if aggregated in data model)
- Weighted average (if using weights)

Usually, after having dropped the variable in the 'values' section, you will use the 'Average' function in the dropdown listed measures:

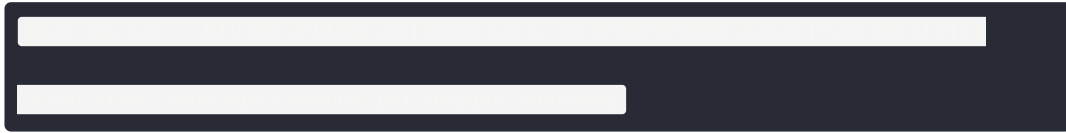
You can also create custom DAX measures for more complex mean calculations. **Examples:**

Example 1: Satisfaction Scores





Example 2: Revenue per Customer



Common Sources:

- `AVERAGE (Table [Metric])`
- `DIVIDE (SUM (Values) , COUNT (Records) )`
- Pre-calculated mean field
- Weighted mean calculation

Count Series

Setting: Count Series

Required: For displaying sample size

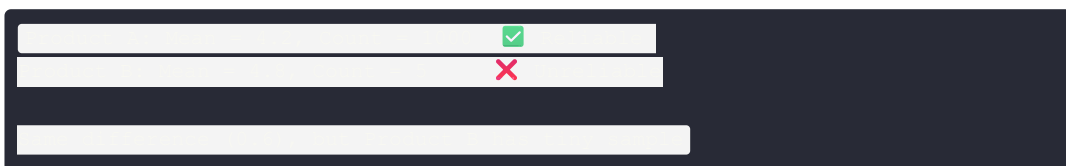
Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

The number of observations used to calculate show the sample size.

What It Shows:

- Sample size (n)
- Number of respondents/records
- Reliability indicator

Why It Matters:



Usually, you will use the 'Count' or 'Count(Distinct)' function in the dropdown listed measures:

You may also create custom DAX measures for specific counting logic. **Examples:**

Example 1: Simple Count

A screenshot of a DAX measure editor. It shows a dark blue background with two white input fields. The first field contains the text 'COUNTROWS(' and the second field contains the text 'Table')'. The formula bar at the bottom shows the complete formula: COUNTROWS(Table).

warning

using COUNTROWS will count all rows, including one which may NOT take part in the calculation. If your variable contains missing or irrelevant data, use the 'Count Rows' function in the dropdown listed functions.

Example 2: Respondent Count

A screenshot of a DAX measure editor. It shows a dark blue background with two white input fields. The first field contains the text 'COUNTROWS(' and the second field contains the text 'Table')'. The formula bar at the bottom shows the complete formula: COUNTROWS(Table).

Example 3: Non-Missing Values

A screenshot of a DAX measure editor. It shows a dark blue background with two white input fields. The first field contains the text 'COUNTROWS(' and the second field contains the text 'Table')'. The formula bar at the bottom shows the complete formula: COUNTROWS(Table).

Display in Table:

A screenshot of a DAX measure editor. It shows a dark blue background with four white input fields. The first field contains the text 'COUNTROWS(' and the second field contains the text 'Table')'. The formula bar at the bottom shows the complete formula: COUNTROWS(Table).

Standard Deviation Series

Setting: Standard Deviation Series

Required: For significance testing and variability analysis

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

The measure of variability/spread in the data. This measure is required for significance testing of mean differences. It is never displayed directly in the table but used in calculations behind the scenes.

Specific Significance Testing Series

Significance Mean Series

Setting: Significance Mean Series

Required: Only if using significance tests

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

Available in: Pro, Premium

There is cases where you may need to provide a different mean series for significance testing than the one used for display, reason why the tool proposes this separate setting. Set here the mean values used for statistical significance testing.

When It Differs from Mean Series:

- Display uses weighted means
- Testing uses unweighted means
- Different aggregation rules for testing

Common Scenarios:

Scenario 1: Same as Mean Series (Most Common)




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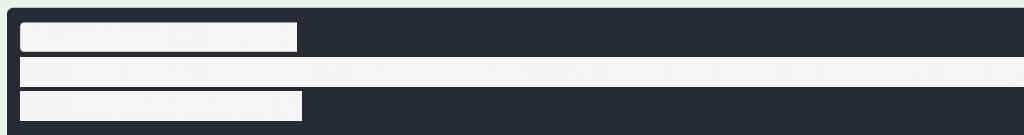
Mean table showing same mean series for display and significance testing

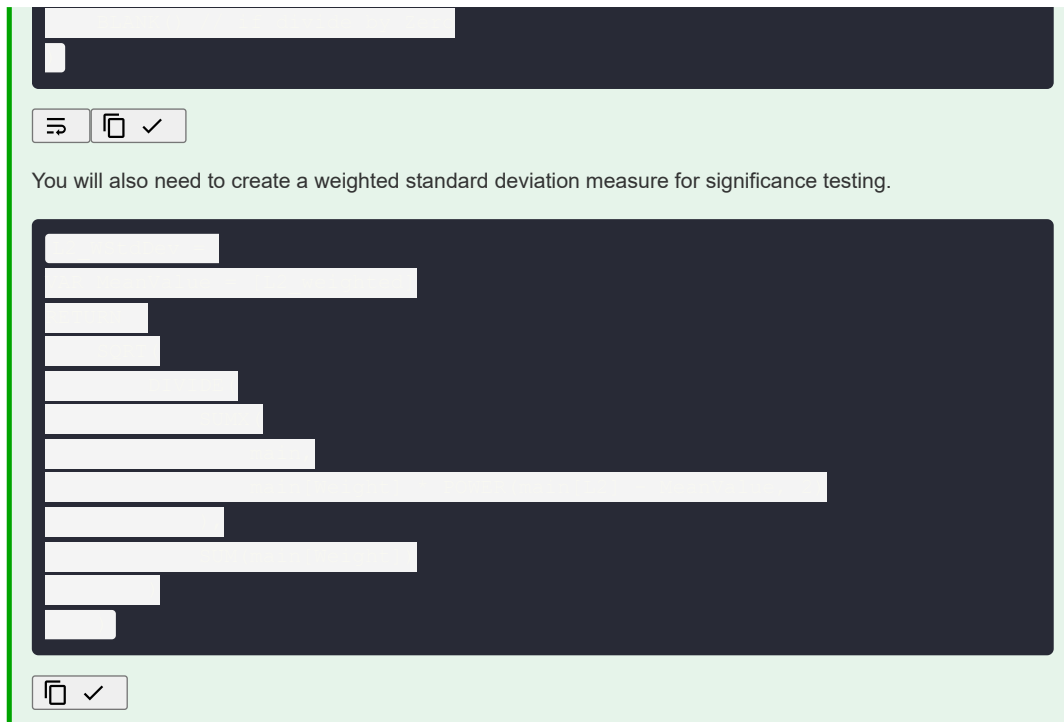
Scenario 2: Different Series



tip

To Create a weighted mean, use "New Measure" in Power BI and entrer a DAX formula like:





Example: Here under are three different settings

- in the first one the 'Mean Series' is set to a raw mean measure with the 'Significance Mean Series' set the same as count Series.
- in the second one the 'Mean Series' is still set to a raw mean measure with the 'Significance Mean Series' and 'Count Series' set to the Weighted measures. With these settings, significance use the weighted population and the weighted mean for testing while the display use the raw mean so values remains the same while significance tests are based differently.
- in the third one the 'Mean Series' is set to a weighted mean measure with the 'Significance Mean Series' set to a raw mean measure and the 'Count Series' set to the raw count measure. With these settings, significance use the raw population and the raw mean for testing while the display use the weighted mean so values differs between display and testing.

Mean table showing the same mean series for display (unweighted) and significance testing (unweighted)	

<i>Mean table showing different mean series for display (weighted) and significance testing (unweighted)</i> <i>Note the difference in the 'Count series' and 'Mean Series for significance tests'</i>	

<i>Mean table showing different mean series for display (unweighted) and significance testing (weighted)</i> <i>Note the difference in the 'Count series' and 'Mean Series for significance tests'</i>	

Why Separate?:

- Research protocols may require unweighted testing
- Different statistical requirements
- Regulatory or methodological standards

Unweighted Base Series

Setting: Unweighted Base Series

Required: Only when using weighted data

Type: Dropdown (lists available measures)

The raw count of observations before weighting adjustments. Used for unweighted base row only, no calculation is made with it.

When to Use:

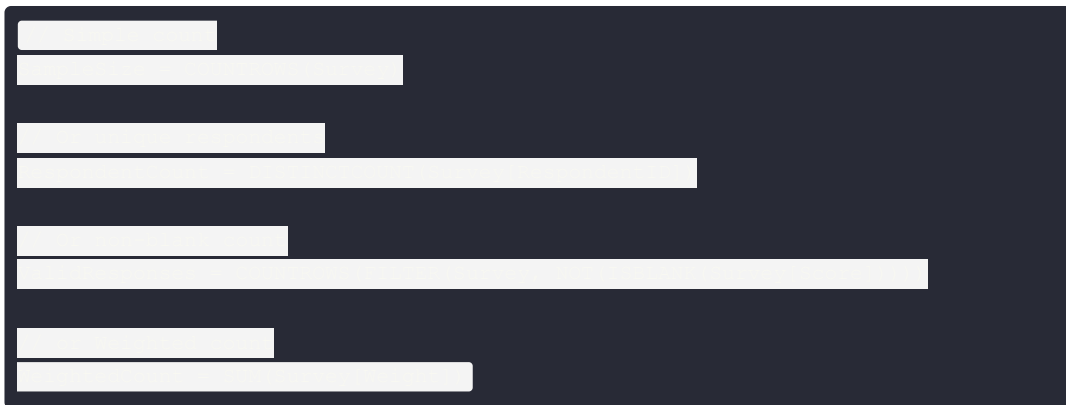
- For research transparency
- To show actual sample sizes

Data Model Requirements**Required Measures for Mean Tables**

1. Mean: Either select 'Average' in the dropdown selection of the continuous variable (raw only) or create a Mean Calculation



2. Count: Either select 'Count' in the dropdown selection (raw), the 'Sum' function of the weight variable or a Size Calculation



warning

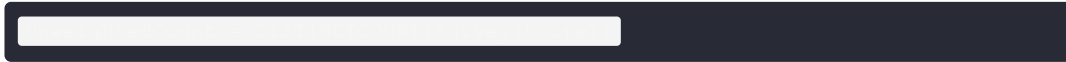
You **SHOULD NOT** Count another variable (like the record ID or respondent ID) as the Average or Std Deviation are calculated upon non-null values of the selected mean variable.

3. Standard Deviation: Either select 'Standard Deviation' in the dropdown selection of the variable or create a Standard Deviation Calculation





4. Unweighted Base : This should ALWAYS be a raw 'count' or 'Count distinct' function of non-null value of selected mean variable

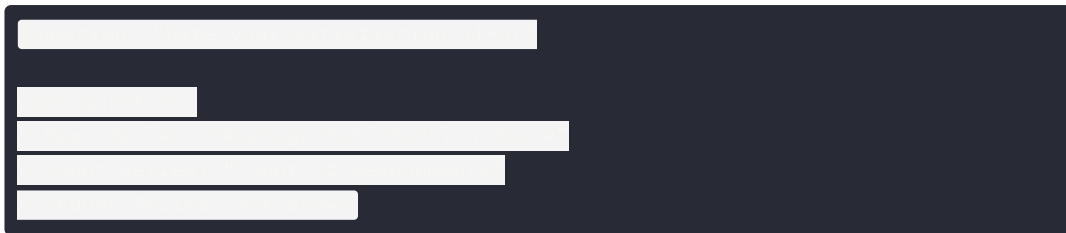


⚠ warning

You **SHOULD NOT** Count another variable (like the record ID or respondent ID) as the Mean or Std Deviation are calculated upon non-null values of the selected mean variable.

Practical Examples

Example 1: Customer Satisfaction Scores



Example 2: Performance Analysis with significance



Example 3: Weighted Research Study



Example 4: Revenue Analysis



Statistical Context

When to Use Mean Tables

Good for:

- Continuous measurements (temperature, time, money)
- Rating scales (1-5, 1-10)
- Satisfaction scores (NPS, CSAT)
- Performance metrics
- Financial averages

Not Good for:

- Categorical data (Yes/No, Male/Female)
- Count data (number of purchases)
- Percentages/proportions
- Binary outcomes

Use percentage tables instead for: Frequency distributions, category breakdowns

Sample Size Considerations

Minimum Sample Sizes:

- **n < 30:** Means unreliable, use caution
- **n = 30-100:** Acceptable for most purposes
- **n > 100:** Reliable means
- **n > 1000:** Very stable estimates

Impact on Significance:

- Large samples detect small differences
- Small samples miss real differences
- Always consider practical significance

Troubleshooting

Q: Mean values look incorrect

A:

- Verify Mean Series calculation in a simple visual first
- Check for filter context issues in DAX
- Ensure measure aggregates correctly across dimensions

Q: Count doesn't match expectations

A:

- Check if counting rows vs distinct IDs
- Verify weighted vs unweighted count
- Look for filter context in measure definition

Q: Standard deviation shows as blank

A:

- Ensure StdDev Series is mapped
- Check that measure returns values
- Verify sufficient data points (need $n \geq 2$)

Q: Unweighted base same as count

A: Your data likely isn't weighted; you can hide unweighted row

Q: Mean tables not available

A: Mean tables require Pro or Premium edition

Q: Significance tests don't work with means

A:

- Verify all three series: Mean, Count, StdDev
- Check Significance Mean Series is configured
- Ensure adequate sample sizes ($n \geq 30$ recommended)

Best Practices

1. **Always Show Count:** Sample size is critical for interpreting means
 2. **Consider StdDev:** Helps understand data consistency
 3. **Test Measures First:** Validate in simple visuals before using in cross-tab
 4. **Document Calculations:** Note whether means are weighted/unweighted
 5. **Check for Outliers:** Extreme values can skew means
 6. **Minimum Samples:** Use thresholds to mask small sample means
 7. **Weighted Data:** Always show both weighted and unweighted counts
 8. **Practical Significance:** A statistically significant 0.1 difference may not matter
-

Related Settings

- [Table Contents](#) — Set table type to "Mean"
 - [Percentage Series](#) — For percentage table configuration
 - [Significance Testing](#) — Configure t-tests for means
 - [Thresholds](#) — Mask means with small samples
 - [Totals & Subtotals](#) — How counts display
-

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#) or contact support.

Thresholds & Masking Reference

ⓘ Coming Soon

Comprehensive guide to threshold settings, warning values, masking rules, and data quality controls.

This section will explain:

- Threshold enablement
- Warning thresholds (visual alerts)
- Mask thresholds (hide values)
- Cell value vs base value rules
- Unweighted base thresholds
- Regex masking patterns
- Empty cells for zero values

See [Table Contents](#) for overview or [Quick Start Guide](#) to start building tables.

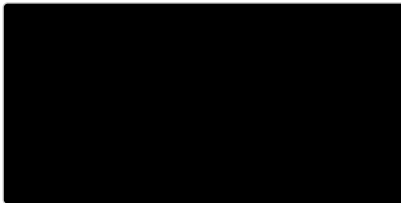
Filtering & Selection Reference

Overview

Enable users to interact with your table by selecting rows or columns headers. This feature allows end-users to filter other page visuals using the SDM Cross Table Tool visualization.

ⓘ Edition Availability

Row and column selection is available in **Pro** and **Premium** editions.



[Selection in SDM Cross Table Tool](#)

Enabling/Disabling Selection

There is two available options to enable or disable selection feature:

- Right click on the table → **Enable Selection**
- In the formatting pane, under **Table Format** section, toggle on or off **Enable Selection**.

Multiple Selection

Power BI does not permit filtering multiple variables at the same time. However, users can select multiple rows or columns within the same variable by holding the Ctrl (or Cmd on Mac) key while clicking on the headers.

Clearing Selection

To clear the current selection:

- Click on the top left corner cell.
- Or click again on the selected row/column while holding the Ctrl (or Cmd) key.
- Right click on the table → **Clear Selection**.
- Disable selection (see previous section).

Selection Behavior

Visual Feedback

When a row or column is selected:

- The selected header highlights with a distinct cell border color
 - Other visuals in your report respond to the selection
 - Create interactive dashboards where users control what data displays
 - Combine with slicers and other Power BI features
-

Limitations & Considerations

- **Data Size:** Very large tables (1000+ rows) may have performance impact
 - **Nested Hierarchies:** Selection on multi-level hierarchies may behave differently
 - **Performance:** Complex cross-filtering with many connected visuals may be slow
-

Troubleshooting

Q: Selection doesn't trigger other visuals to update

A: Check Power BI cross-filtering settings. Ensure other visuals have cross-filter enabled.

Q: Users can't multi-select rows/columns

A: Multi-select depends on browser and Power BI version. Single selection always works.

Q: Selected row/column doesn't highlight

A: Check that Enable Selection is turned on in formatting panel

Q: Selection performance is slow

A: Large tables (1000+ rows) may be slow. Consider data aggregation or pagination.

Q: Selection is grayed out/unavailable

A: Row and Column Selection requires Pro or Premium edition

For more help, see the [Quick Start Guide](#).